

Executive Summary

AI Agent Platform Assessment — Financial Services

June 2026 | Public Information Only | Elo + Monte Carlo Scoring

Decision

Is Salesforce Agentforce the best-fit agent platform for a Financial Services client (CIO-driven, Azure estate, high tech debt, hybrid ERP) across CRM/Sales, Customer Service, Operations, and HR? Or should Microsoft Copilot Studio, ServiceNow AI Agents, or a custom-build on Azure OpenAI be pursued instead?

Recommendation

Validate Further — Domain-Driven Hybrid | Confidence: 62%

No single platform wins across all four domains. The Elo + Monte Carlo scoring reveals overlapping 90% confidence intervals for the top 3 options, making a single-platform recommendation premature. The data supports a domain-driven approach:

- **CRM/Sales + Customer Service:** Agentforce (if confirmed on Salesforce CRM). Native CRM grounding, FS-specific Voice agents, and top scores in both customer-facing domains.
- **Operations / HR + Azure-native workloads:** Copilot Studio as the primary contender. Azure-native alignment, potential to burn down EDP commitments, and the most consistent cross-domain performance.
- **Enterprise Governance Layer:** ServiceNow AI Control Tower for cross-platform agent governance across all deployed platforms.
- **Custom-build on Azure OpenAI:** Not recommended. 0% probability of ranking first, 3-6+ month development timeline, and no pre-built agents or governance.

Stack Ranking

#	Option	Score	MC Mean	90% CI	P(Rank 1)
1	Copilot Studio	66.8	63.5	[50.9, 75.5]	49.6%
2	ServiceNow AI	60.6	60.5	[51.3, 70.0]	27.5%
3	Agentforce	56.8	59.9	[50.3, 70.6]	23.0%
4	Custom Azure OpenAI	26.6	26.0	[17.1, 34.6]	0.0%

Top Risks

1. **CRM platform assumption:** If the client is NOT on Salesforce CRM, Agentforce's CRM/Sales domain advantage evaporates, and Copilot Studio or a custom approach may surpass it.
2. **Azure EDP unknown:** If significant Azure committed spend exists, Copilot Studio and custom-build economics improve substantially — potentially making Copilot Studio the clear leader.
3. **Multi-platform complexity:** A domain-driven hybrid approach (Agentforce + Copilot Studio + ServiceNow governance) introduces integration complexity, multi-vendor management, and potential data fragmentation. The POC should explicitly test cross-platform agent handoff.

Cost Headline

The volumetric cost analysis was not run for this assessment because client-specific pricing, volumes, and Azure EDP details are unavailable. Based on public pricing research: Agentforce Year 1 runs \$150K–\$600K (mid-market) including mandatory Data Cloud at \$108K+/yr. Copilot Studio starts at \$200/mo per 25K credits tenant-wide plus \$30/user/mo for M365 Copilot (\$66–87/user/mo all-in). ServiceNow pricing requires a client-specific quote. All three represent material cost centers; the key differentiator is whether costs can align with existing Azure commitments (advantage: Copilot Studio and custom-build).

Next Steps

4. **Run a 4-week POC** comparing Agentforce (CRM/CS domains) against Copilot Studio (Ops/HR + Azure alignment) to validate the domain-driven hypothesis with real client data.
5. **Gather client documents** (see Data Gathering Request): CRM platform confirmation, Azure EDP details, and ServiceNow deployment status are the three P1 items that would most shift the ranking.
6. **Model cost scenarios** using the volumetric framework with client-specific volumes and live Azure pricing to produce a by-layer, by-environment cost comparison.

Methodology

Scoring: Elo round-robin per criterion (8 criteria, 6 pairwise matches each, 48 total judgments) + Monte Carlo confidence bands (10,000 trials, fixed seed=7 for reproducibility). Full pairwise coverage, zero intransitive triples. Criterion weights derived from intake profile. All pairwise judgments carry written rationales tied to specific client requirements. No Anthropic/Claude/alliance bias — see the Impartiality and Anti-Bias Rules in the full assessment. Data sources: public web search only (June 2026).